

Been vs Gone

CEFR B1

Lesson Pack · summary, worksheet & answer key

Quick answer

Both come from 'go', but they tell you where the person is now:

- 1 have been (to) = went and returned (I've been to the shops — I'm back).
- 2 have gone (to) = went and is still there (He's gone to work — he's out).

'Been' can also mean 'visited in your life' (I've been to Japan). 'Gone' always means the person is still away.

At a glance

Structure	Meaning	Where are they now?
have/has been (to)	went and came back	here / returned
have/has gone (to)	went and is still there	away / not here

Learning objectives

- Can distinguish 'have been (to)' (returned) from 'have gone (to)' (still away) (CEFR B1).
- Can use 'have been to' for life experience.
- Can choose the right one based on where the person is now.

Practice worksheet

Circle the correct option. Been vs Gone · CEFR B1

Name: _____

Date: _____

1. "Where were you?" "I've ____ to the shops. Look, I bought bread."

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|---------|----------|
| A. been | B. gone |
| C. went | D. being |

2. "Where's Dad?" "He's ____ to the garage — he'll be back soon."

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|---------|----------|
| A. gone | B. been |
| C. went | D. being |

3. I've ____ to Japan twice in my life.

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|---------|----------|
| A. been | B. gone |
| C. went | D. being |

4. She's not here — she's ____ to a meeting.

- | | |
|---------|----------|
| A. gone | B. been |
| C. went | D. being |

5. "You look tired." "Yes, I've just ____ to the gym."

- | | |
|---------|----------|
| A. been | B. gone |
| C. went | D. being |

6. They've ____ on holiday and won't be back until Sunday.

- | | |
|---------|----------|
| A. gone | B. been |
| C. went | D. being |

7. Have you ever ____ to a live concert?

- | | |
|---------|----------|
| A. been | B. gone |
| C. went | D. being |

8. The kids aren't home — they've ____ to school.

- | | |
|---------|----------|
| A. gone | B. been |
| C. went | D. being |

9. Correct this: 'How was Rome?' 'Great! I've gone there last week.'

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| A. Great! I've been there. / I went there last week. | B. Great! I've gone there last week. |
| C. Great! I've being there last week. | D. The sentence is already correct. |

10. 'Has gone to' tells you the person is...

- | | |
|--|--------------------|
| A. still away. | B. back home. |
| C. someone with experience of a place. | D. about to leave. |

Answer key

Correct answers with explanations · for the teacher

1. **A. been** — You're back, so 'been': 'I've been to the shops'.
2. **A. gone** — He's still away, so 'gone': 'He's gone to the garage'.
3. **A. been** — Life experience takes 'been': 'I've been to Japan'.
4. **A. gone** — She's still away, so 'gone'.
5. **A. been** — You're back and telling them, so 'been'.
6. **A. gone** — They're still away, so 'gone'.
7. **A. been** — Experience question takes 'been': 'Have you ever been...?'
8. **A. gone** — They're still away, so 'gone'.
9. **A. Great! I've been there. / I went there last week.** — You're back, so 'been' (and with 'last week', past simple 'went').
10. **A. still away.** — 'Has gone to' = went and is still away.